AKSHAY KALAPGAR

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SUMMARY

AI and full-stack engineer with 5+ years of engineering experience since 2020, building production AI agents, real-time voice AI and the evals and guardrails that keep them reliable. At Climb Together I took Goldi, a voice AI career agent, from prototype to production for 100K+ users through a Walmart partnership. At Softmax I built an MCP tool harness and Claude Code plugin system used daily by 20 engineers. I own work end-to-end, from architecture and data to product and deployment.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Full Stack: TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Redis, REST, GraphQL, Python (FastAPI), Java (Spring Boot); Jest, Playwright

AI Agents & LLMs: production LLM apps, agents, tool calling, multi-turn state, RAG and people/context search, personalization; Claude, OpenAI, Vercel AI SDK, LangChain, LangGraph, MCP, Claude Code

Voice & Conversational AI: real-time speech-to-text (Deepgram Nova-3) over WebSocket, text-to-speech (Cartesia, ElevenLabs), VAD turn-taking and barge-in, Hume EVI, Vapi, Twilio SMS/WhatsApp

Search & Data: Elasticsearch, pgvector, Redis caching, event-driven pipelines, idempotent integrations; PostHog product analytics, A/B testing

Infra & Reliability: AWS (Lambda, EKS, IAM), Vercel, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, GitHub Actions; Datadog, OpenTelemetry, Sentry; evals, guardrails and regression gates

EXPERIENCE

Full Stack Developer & AI Engineer @ Climb Together, San Francisco, CA *May 2025 - Present*

- Took Goldi, an AI career agent (TypeScript/Node.js, Next.js, Claude, OpenAI, Vercel AI SDK, LangChain), from prototype to production for **100K+ users through a Walmart partnership**, owning architecture, product UX, the agent and the PostgreSQL data layer.
- Built Goldi's real-time voice conversations: Deepgram Nova-3 streaming speech-to-text, Claude for reasoning and Cartesia text-to-speech, with turn-taking and barge-in, so users could talk through their career and goals naturally.
- Built the agent's tool calling and multi-turn state so it understood a user's intent and background and took real actions (career guidance, routing, follow-ups), with RAG over career content for grounded answers.
- Scoped features from user feedback and product data; used PostHog to find where the agent misread intent or picked the wrong tool, then fixed prompts and tools: **+28% re-engagement**.
- Built an evaluation harness (routing and adversarial suites, LLM judges against a 123-claim grounding gold set, cost-budget gating) so new models and prompts shipped without regressions.
- Built idempotent, event-driven integrations (Twilio SMS/WhatsApp, TalentLMS, Walmart routing) with race-condition fixes and safe retries.

AI Platform Engineer (Contract) @ Softmax Inc, San Francisco, CA *Nov 2025 - Apr 2026*

- Built an MCP tool harness and Claude Code plugin system of **86 skills across 6 plugins**, **used daily by 20 engineers** for autonomous PR review, code generation and multi-file edits; defined every tool's schema, inputs and limits.
- Designed the guardrail boundary between LLM reasoning and execution (input validation, scoped tool access, human-review gates) and built the evaluation layer that caught regressions between releases.
- Built a 21-table PostgreSQL schema, a Kubernetes watcher that classifies and heals failed AI jobs, Datadog and OpenTelemetry tracing, and Terraform on AWS.

Software Engineer Intern @ UMass Chan Medical School, Boston, MA *May 2024 - Jan 2025*

- Led Factorbook 2.0 (React, Next.js, GraphQL): **55% lower API latency**; migrated the backend to AWS Lambda; 500+ tests gating every deploy.

Full Stack Engineer @ Capgemini, Mumbai, India *Aug 2021 - Aug 2023*

- Built 10+ Java/Spring Boot microservices for **BMW's global platform (200K+ users, 99.9% uptime)**; owned CI/CD and mentored 4 developers.

OPEN SOURCE & PROJECTS

- **secure-agent-service** (open source; C#/.NET, Microsoft Agent Framework): support agent with identity propagation, least-privilege tools, approval gates, audit log and ACL-filtered RAG with citations.
- **mcp-policy-gateway** (open source; Go): MCP gateway with OAuth 2.1, signed Cedar policy bundles, credential mediation and hash-chained audit.
- **agent-harness-lab** (open source; Python): sandboxed tools, durable journaled runs that resume after a crash, record/replay evals. Plus **1,180+ commits** to open-source Metta AI.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

M.S. Computer Science, Clark University (GPA 3.8, 2025) · **B.E. Information Technology**, University of Mumbai (GPA 3.6, 2021)

Certifications: AWS Certified Developer - Associate (2024) · AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner · IBM Applied AI · IBM Data Science